

Opinion of the Court

Clearstream and/or UBAE ha[d] some form of beneficial or equitable interest.”).²⁰

In any event, a statute does not impinge on judicial power when it directs courts to apply a new legal standard to undisputed facts. “When a plaintiff brings suit to enforce a legal obligation it is not any the less a case or controversy upon which a court possessing the federal judicial power may rightly give judgment, because the plaintiff’s claim is uncontested or incontestable.” *Pope v. United States*, 323 U.S. 1, 11 (1944). In *Schooner Peggy*, 1 Cranch, at 109–110, for example, this Court applied a newly ratified treaty that, by requiring the return of captured property, effectively permitted only one possible outcome. And in *Robertson*, 503 U.S., at 434–435, 438–439, a statute replaced governing environmental-law restraints on timber harvesting with new

²⁰ The District Court understandably concluded that § 8772 left it “plenty . . . to adjudicate.” App. to Pet. for Cert. 115a. For one, the statute did not define its key terms, “beneficial interest” and “equitable title.” To arrive at fitting definitions, the District Court consulted legal dictionaries and precedent. See *id.*, at 111a–112a; *Zivotofsky v. Clinton*, 566 U.S. 189, 196 (2012) (Interpretation of statutes “is a familiar judicial exercise.”). Further, § 8772 required the District Court to determine whether the Bank owned the assets in question. § 8772(a)(2)(A). Clearstream contended that there were triable issues as to whether Bank Markazi was the owner of the blocked assets. App. to Pet. for Cert. 37a–39a, 111a. The court rejected that contention, finding that Clearstream and UBAE were merely accountholders, maintaining the assets “on behalf of” the Bank. *Id.*, at 112a–113a; see *id.*, at 38a–39a. Next, § 8772 required the court to determine whether any party, other than the Bank, possessed a “constitutionally protected interest” in the assets. § 8772(a)(2)(B). Clearstream argued that it had such an interest, but the court disagreed. App. to Pet. for Cert. 117a–118a (determining that Clearstream had no constitutionally protected “investment-backed expectatio[n]” in the assets). Finally, prior to the statute’s enactment, Bank Markazi and Clearstream had argued that the assets in question were located in Luxembourg, not New York. *Supra*, at 223. Leaving the issue for court resolution, Congress, in § 8772(a)(1)(A), required the District Court to determine whether the assets were “held in the United States.”